

Subject: Tourism & Hospitality

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Paper: 07, Front Office Operations & Management

Module: 34, Travel Formalities and Regulations



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ITEMS	DESCRIPTION OF MODULE
Subject Name	Tourism & Hospitality
Paper Name	Front Office Operations and Management
Module Title	Travel Formalities and Regulations
Module Id	Module no-34
Pre- Requisites	Basic knowledge about Travel Formalities and Regulations
Objectives	To understand the various formalities and documentation required while travelling
Keywords	Travel Formalities, Regulations, documentation, Native and Host country

QUADRANT-I

Sr. No.	TITLE
1	Learning Objectives
2	Introduction
3	Travel Formalities/Inspection
4	Passport
5	VISA
6	Compulsory Vaccination
7	Permits for Restricted Areas
8	Travel Insurance
9	Foreign Exchange
11	Conclusion

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

After completing this module students will be able to:

- Understand why Travel Formalities and regulations are important
- Learn various types of travel documentation
- Understand the types and procedure of obtaining these documents
- To understand the genesis of travel regulations

TRAVEL FORMALITIES & REGULATIONS

INTRODUCTION

Tourism can be stated as the largest and rapidly growing industries across the profitable market segmentation. Advancement in means of transportation is the reason travelling becomes very fast and people are crossing the geographical boundaries for several reasons. Therefore, Tourism Professionals must be fully aware about all the rules and regulations affecting the outbound travel in directly and indirectly manner and they should be thorough with all the latest happenings in this regard as the tourists visiting any part of the world are governed by rules and regulations of both the countries i.e. native and host countries.

These rules and regulations are quite important for the security of the host country. These formalities help and prevent the illegal movement of illegal migrants and criminals. They also help the country to limit illegal entry of the unauthorised goods such as drugs, animal hides, arms, explosives etc.

These formalities before the movement of the tourist from own country to other country ensure the safety of country being visited. The formalities are in the form of documents and endorsement which are solicited well in advance. The tourist must induce authentic passport and visa before consummating the technicalities of travel. Without the precondition documents travel is not possible overseas.

In India there are no boundations to travel in different states once one gets the visa, except for the border line areas and the islands for which a special permit is required as the forth said are very high security lands. However, a traveller who wants to go outside of his native country for the purpose of recreational activities has to undergo certain formalities/inspections before starting his travel.

1. Prime Inspection

During the elementary inspection, Passport, Visa (when required), Compulsory vaccinations, Travel insurance, foreign exchange, restricted area permit are the documents required from a traveller:

2. Backup Inspection

After the primary inspection, a secondary inspection is conducted by the Bureau of immigration to protect the susceptible victims of human trafficking and subjective outlawed recruitment drives by checking the following prospects such as age, educational qualification, fiscal capacity to travel etc.

If the traveller is not financially able to travel around the desired destinations then he shall need an endorsement certificate, stating the relationship with the above mentioned endorser.

Passport

A passport is a canonical and decisive testimony issued by the endowed public authority of a nation to its nationals. It is the first step of the many steps in order to be a legitimate traveller to any country, border or port of any country. A legal passport assures the traveller to visit different destinations without any deterrent or moratorium. The passport is the document of highest legal and authoritative value of legalised entity of the person, trying to travel or leave the country. It also serves as the validatory verification of the person.

Passport also assures the host country of the legitimacy of the traveller. The passport is issued in the name of the country, i.e. the President/Chancellor/King etc. It is a booklet issued to the holder from the issuing authority of external affairs.

Passport shows the holders international identity, which gradually becomes the holder's national status in the different parts of the world and official permission to pass the port.

Orthodox passports subsume information likethe holder's name,signature,place and date of birth,photograph, and other identifying information.

To be credible for international travel, the passport must be used within the period of validity specified on it. To travel to a foreign country along with passport the person has to the visa permission from the embassy of the host country. Then on the basis of this document along with the visa and endorsements the particular person is allowed to penetrate the destination for a specific period of time mentioned on the visa details.

Generally a passport is valid for all the countries, but if there are any exceptions of the country, there name will be specifically and separately mentioned.

To apply for a passport the person should be a citizen of the country he is applying passport to.

Citizenship is given to that citizen who is member of the state or commonwealth, either native or naturalized.

A citizenship is bestowed under following conditions:-

- By birth
- Through parents
- By normalisation
- Political asylum
- Through marriage
- Through honour or invitation

There are three types of passports available in India are –

- **The Regular Indian passport**

This type of passport is issued to common citizens and VIPs and is used for regular or ordinary travel on personal grounds. Also called as Type P or P-Type (P indicating personal), this passport comes in booklets of either 36 pages or 60 pages. These passports do not provide any special privileges to the holder.

- **The Official Indian passport**

This passport is typically issued to Govt. employees who are travelling on national duty, to represent their country and individuals who are fully dependent on officials on the Indian Foreign Service (Branch A& B). Such passports are not issued to individuals traveling for overseas assignments of official state business. No special privileges are enjoyed by the holder of an Official passport

- **The Diplomatic Indian passport**

Probably the most elite kind of passport, the Diplomatic Indian Passport is given to top ranking govt. officials, consuls, and top officials of the Indian Foreign Service travelling on duty, their dependents and essentially, anyone appointed with the status of a Diplomat. It is to be noted that carrying a Diplomatic passport does not bestow you with Diplomatic immunity, which is something that is bestowed separately.

Category		Type	Color	Issued to
Regular	Indian	Type-P (personal)	Dark navy blue	General public

Passport			
Official Indian Passport	Type-S (service)	White	Representatives of the country travelling on official business
Diplomatic Indian Passport	Type-D (Diplomatic)	Maroon	Top ranking Govt. officials and Indian Diplomats

(Source: - Ministry of External Affairs)

Documents required while applying for Passport.

Photographs

The person requires 3 recent passport size photographs in color showcasing the front view of the complete face.

Address

- A) Ration card
- B) Election card
- C) Bank account statement
- D) Telephone bill
- E) Electricity bill
- F) Employer certificate on company's letterhead
- G) Gas connection bill

Birth proof

Copies of original birth certificate

Citizenship document

Check whether the person applying for the passport is a citizen of the country by birth or by registration.

Identity certificate

The identity certificate for the following should be submitted in original.

- a) Government
- b) Public sector
- c) Employees of statutory bodies

No objection certificate

If the person applying for the passport is government official, then this document should be submitted in original.

Affidavit/marriage certificate

For change of name on the passport after the person gets married.

Letter of authority

This letter is required for the travel agents.

Visa

This stands for **Visitors Intended Stay Abroad**. It is the patent which concedes the citizen of one country to travel other country for mentioned period of time and a designated purpose. VISA is issued by the embassy of the host country situated in the visiting person's country. The VISA is usually said to be bilateral agreement between two countries.

A VISA is an avenue made by diplomatic official of a government in a passport or other travel document, which indicates that the bearer has been granted permission to enter or re-enter the host country. VISA comprises of following details;

- A) Authorized length of stay
- B) The period of validity
- C) The number of times a person is allowed entry i.e. that may single or multiple entry, during that period.

A single entry visa will not be valid if it has been used once, even though the validity date has not expired. In case of multiple entry visas, its validity expires on the date of expiry. The date of entry stamp is imprinted on the

passport when a person arrives in the country concerned (this stamp can be placed on the page bearing the visa or on another page of the passport, which gradually shows that the visa has been used). Entry to host country is almost confirmed when the traveler gets the visa, but the final decision regarding the entry is taken by the immigration officials at the entry point, as they have the authority to deny the entry to any traveler if they find anything suspicious.

Visa helps the immigration department of the host country to keep a tab on the number of visitors that are likely to travel and from a country. Visas are also required for children. If a child travels on adult passport, the visa in that passport must mention that it is valid for both, the child as well as the adult concerned.

The visa is granted in form of a rubber stamp on a passport or an endorsement. If embassy or consulate is not available in the country to issue the visa then it becomes necessary to send the passport to the country where travel is intended in order to get the permission in form of visa.

There are countries for which you don't have get permission prior the arrival. Such countries issue visa on arrival i.e. Hong Kong, Malaysia, Thailand, and Mauritius etc. The intended traveler should first make sure they have a valid citizenship and visa requirements for the country he/she intend to visit.

Types of visa

Government of India issues the following visas:

- 1) e-Visa
- 2) Business Visa
- 3) Conference Visa
- 4) Diplomatic Visa
- 5) Employment Visa
- 6) Emergency Visa

- 7) Entry Visa
- 8) Journalist Visa
- 9) Medical Visa
- 10) Missionaries Visa
- 11) Permit to re-enter within 2 months
- 12) Research Visa
- 13) Student Visa
- 14) Tourist Visa
- 15) Transit Visa
- 16) Intern Visa Film Visa

Compulsory Vaccination

Whatever the destination, the best possible pre-travel preparation is essential to protect the health of traveller while away. Some vaccines are compulsory, and they can face difficulty crossing borders without correct documentation. Other vaccines are highly recommended for their own health and safety, but they will not be asked for documentation while passing International borders.

There are two types of immunizations, which are compulsory and recommended. The compulsory vaccinations are only required by certain countries. Some countries may recommend certain immunizations, especially when the traveller normally travels outside the urban areas.

The travellers should therefore be advised to obtain a health certificate, proving that they have been vaccinated for a specified infectious disease. If they are not able to produce the same, they could be deported back out of the country or they could be detained and kept in quarantine.

An internationally recognized certificate is required by the traveller if they have to be vaccinated against a certain disease. The certificate has to be produced by traveller at the point of entry into the country.

The WHO international certificate of vaccination can usually be obtained from health clinics, doctors, and health authorities. In order for the certificate of vaccination to be valid, it must bear the name of vaccination, the date, and should be signed by the concerned authorities in the country of issue. Cholera and yellow fever are the only vaccinations which are normally required for travelling to certain countries.

Special Permits for Restricted Areas

Non-Indian citizens are not allowed to visit certain protected areas in India (mainly North-East) according to the Foreigners (Protected Area) Order 1958. They need to obtain a Protected Area Permit (PAP) to visit these protected areas. Indian citizens who are not resident in these areas are also required to get an Inner Line Permit (ILP) to enter these places.

According to the Foreigners (Restricted Area) Order 1968, non-Indian citizens are not allowed to visit certain restricted areas in India. They are required to obtain a Restricted Area Permit (RAP) to visit these areas in India. As of 2009, non-Indians need RAP to visit Union Territory of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands and parts of the state of Sikkim.

Why Should One Get Protected / Restricted Area Permit

- For security reasons and protection.
- To disallow permanent stay of Foreign Citizen who find it difficult to settle with their family abroad and want to settle permanently in Protected/Restricted Areas of India.

- For tourism.

Note- Long-term or permanent permits are not given to non-Indian family members, not even to NRIs (persons of Indian origin but foreign citizens now).

Areas for which a Protected Area Permit is required:

1. All of Nagaland
2. All of Sikkim
3. Parts of Arunachal Pradesh
4. Specific regions of Himachal Pradesh
5. Specific regions of Jammu and Kashmir
6. Specific regions of Manipur
7. Specific regions of Mizoram
8. Border areas of Rajasthan
9. Parts of Uttarakhand

Areas for which a Restricted Area Permit is required:

1. Andaman and Nicobar
2. High alert areas of Sikkim

The Restricted Area Permit is issued by:

Ministry of Home affairs, Government of India, All Foreigner Regional Registration Offices (FRRO), Chief Immigration Officer, Immigration Officer.

The Protected Area Permit can be issued by:

1. Ministry of Home affairs, Government of India, LoK Nayak Bhawan, New Delhi
2. All Foreigner Regional Registration Offices (FRRO) at Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Amritsar, Hyderabad and Bangalore
3. All Indian Mission Abroad

Application Process: How to Get Protected / Restricted Area Permit

1. Download the RAP application form from here - <http://www.in.ckgs.us/resources/pdf/rap-permit-form.pdf> and RAP application form from here- <http://www.indischebotschaft.de/downloads/RAP-form.pdf>
2. Submit the application form in person or by post to the closest Indian Mission in your nation prior the visit. If you are already here submit the requisite application to any of the authorities, delegated the powers to issue such a special permit.
3. On arrival, you are required to report at FRRO office of the district you are visiting within 24 hours of the arrival. You will be issued the PAP/RAP with a limited days validity depending upon the state you visit.

Documents required for Protected / Restricted Area Permit

- 3 copies of Filled-in Application Form
- 2 Copies of the applicant passport
- 2 passport photographs

Travel Insurance

Having this insurance is very important aspect of the travel planning. It helps the travellers by giving a perfect prior safeguard against adverse situations from the time the journey starts. Before selecting the insurance plan the traveller should look at these following facts of the policy:

- a) **Compensation for flight Issues-** a travel insurance policy provides you with compensation in certain cases, including flight delay or cancellation. This usually is covered in case of travelling abroad. You will be provided with accommodation during the waiting period.
- b) **Medical Emergency & Hospitalisation:** - This type of policy covers the cost of medical emergencies that a traveller faces when he is on the move and is in need of any financial help while away from the home. The policy will normally cover all reasonable medical, surgical, hospital, and nursing fees incurred overseas, as a result of bodily injury, illness, or disease, to relieve pain.

- c) **Travel and Accommodation:** - This clause covers any emergency causing trip termination or delay. In the meanwhile, expenses arising out of hotel accommodation, in-between transportation, air ambulance (if required due to a medical emergency), etc. are settled under the coverage of your travel insurance policy.
- d) **Legal Liability and Expenses:-** This clause covers the traveller in case of any unfortunate incident that the traveller becomes reason for. These include death or damage to health or the property of the sufferer.

Benefits of travel insurance

- a) If the flight is delayed, meal reimbursements are given.
- b) In case of lost passport, quick assistance is provided.
- c) Emergency medical help is provided when needed.
- d) Basic requirements are provided, in case of luggage lost.
- e) In case of disaster, heading back home is made quickly.
- f) It is mandatory to take travel insurance for some countries to travel in.
- g) Immunity is provided in case of Travel Company's bankruptcy.
- h) Makes the trip economic.
- i) Gives maximum coverage at minimum cost.

Foreign Exchange

Person going abroad for immigration can draw foreign exchange upto US\$ 5,000 or the amount prescribed by the country of emigration from an authorised dealer in India. These amount is only to meet the incidental expenses in the country of migration. No amount of foreign exchange can be remitted outside India to become eligible or for earning points or credits for immigration. All such remittances require prior permission of the Reserve Bank.

Source- Reserve bank of India.

1) Limit of foreign exchange on return to India

Residents are permitted to hold foreign currency up to US\$2,000 or its equivalent provided the foreign exchange was -

- a. acquired by him while on a visit to any place outside India by way of payment for services not arising from any business in or anything done in India;

Or

- b. acquired by him, from any person not resident in India and who is on a visit to India, as honorarium or gift or for services rendered or in settlement of any lawful obligation,

Or

- c. acquired by him by way of honorarium or gift while on a visit to any place outside India;

Or

- d. Acquired by him from an authorised person for travel abroad and represents the unspent amount thereof.

Source- Reserve bank of India.

2) While coming into India how much foreign exchange can be brought in by the traveller

A person coming into India from abroad can bring with him foreign exchange without any limit provided if foreign currency notes, or travellers cheques exceed US\$ 10,000/- or its equivalent and/or the value of foreign currency exceeds US\$ 5,000/- or its equivalent, it should be declared to the Customs Authorities at the Airport in the Currency Declaration Form (CDF), on arrival in India

Source- Reserve bank of India.

Conclusion

Information regarding various travel formalities such as passport, visa, vaccination, restricted area permits, foreign exchange etc. and various regulations regarding foreign travel are becoming more and more relevant as people are travelling more frequently. These formalities facilitate smooth travel and stay of tourists at the destination and also affect overall travel experience. Without prior and proper information tourists will face many difficulties and their travel experience will turn into a nightmare. Therefore the tourism professionals should arrange all the documents and complete all formalities regarding travel. This chapter will give a deep insight into the various formalities and regulations regarding foreign travels.

